

John 1:1–2: The Word, the Trinity, and the Preexistence of Christ

John 1:1–2

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. He was with God in the beginning.”¹

These verses contain profound theological truth in just a few words. John, under the inspiration of the Holy Spirit, introduces Jesus not first as a man, a teacher, or even a Savior—but as the eternal Word, who is both with God and God.

¹ Unless otherwise noted, all Scripture quotations in this paper are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB).

1. The Word Preexisted Time and Creation

“In the beginning was the Word...”

Before anything was created, the Word already was. This shows the preexistence of Christ. He did not come into being—He simply was. This parallels the opening of Genesis:

Genesis 1:1 – “In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth.”

John intentionally echoes Genesis to show that before creation, the Word already existed. He was not created—He is eternal.

Micah 5:2 – “But you, Bethlehem Ephrathah, who are one of the little clans of Judah, out of you will come for Me One to be ruler over Israel—One whose origins are of old, from the days of eternity.”

Colossians 1:17 – “He is before all things, and in Him all things hold together.”

2. The Word Is the Creator

“Through Him all things were made, and without Him nothing was made that has been made.”
— **John 1:3**

John does not merely tell us that the Word existed before creation. He identifies the Word as the One through whom creation itself came into being. Everything that was made came through Him.

Therefore, the Word cannot Himself be part of the created order. He is the eternal Creator, not a creature.

This truth is reinforced throughout the New Testament:

Colossians 1:16 – “For in Him all things were created, things in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or rulers or authorities. All things were created through Him and for Him.”

Hebrews 1:2 – “But in these last days He has spoken to us by His Son, whom He appointed heir of all things, and through whom He made the universe.”

The One through whom all things were created must Himself exist before and beyond the created order.

3. The Word Was With God – A Distinct Person

“...and the Word was with God...”

This phrase teaches personal distinction within the Godhead. The Word is not the same Person as the Father.

The Greek expression *pros ton Theon* conveys personal relationship and distinction. The Word was not merely an impersonal attribute or force; He was personally “with God”—in relationship with the Father.

1 John 1:2 – “And this is the life that was revealed; we have seen it and testify to it, and we proclaim to you the eternal life that was with the Father and was revealed to us.”

Here we see that Jesus was with the Father before He was revealed to the world.

4. The Word Was God – Equality with God

“...and the Word was God.”

This is the clearest declaration of the deity of Christ. The Word is not a lesser being or a created god. He is God in essence, nature, and being.

Philippians 2:6 – “Who, existing in the form of God, did not consider equality with God something to be grasped.”

Hebrews 1:3 – “The Son is the radiance of God’s glory and the exact representation of His nature, upholding all things by His powerful word.”

The Greek grammar is significant. In the phrase *kai Theos ēn ho Logos*, the noun *Theos* does not have the definite article, while *ho Logos* does. This construction does not mean “the Word was a god.” Rather, it emphasizes the nature or essence of the Word: the Word was truly God while remaining personally distinct from the Father.

John has carefully expressed both truths—distinction of persons and unity of divine nature.

5. Distinct Yet United – The Trinity

From these statements, we see that:

- The Word is eternal—He existed before creation.
- The Word is the Creator—all things were made through Him.
- The Word is distinct from the Father—He was “with God.”
- The Word is fully divine—He “was God.”

This forms the basis of Trinitarian theology. The Father and the Son are not the same Person, yet they are both fully God, and together with the Holy Spirit, they are one God in three Persons.

Matthew 28:19 – “Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.”

2 Corinthians 13:14 – “The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with all of you.”

Note the singular “name,” followed by the three distinct Persons of the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. This provides a striking biblical expression of the unity and distinction found within the Godhead.

6. The Word Became Flesh – The Incarnation

John 1:14 – “The Word became flesh and made His dwelling among us. We have seen His glory, the glory of the one and only Son from the Father, full of grace and truth.”

The eternal, divine Word did not remain distant—He entered time and space, taking on human flesh without ceasing to be God.

This is the mystery and miracle of the Incarnation: the uncreated Creator became part of His creation to redeem it.

Galatians 4:4 – “But when the time had fully come, God sent His Son, born of a woman, born under the law.”

The One who existed eternally with the Father entered human history as Jesus Christ. The Creator became part of His creation, yet without surrendering His divine nature.

Conclusion: A Foundation for Faith

John 1:1–3 and 1:14 reveal that Jesus Christ:

- Is eternal—existing before creation and not part of the created order.
- Is the Creator—all things were made through Him.
- Is distinct from the Father—yet in perfect fellowship with Him.
- Is fully God—not lesser and not created.
- Is the foundation of the doctrine of the Trinity.
- Became flesh to dwell among us.

These truths are not merely abstract doctrines—they are foundational to the gospel. The One who redeems us is not merely a created intermediary but the eternal Son of God who entered His creation to save it.

Only a divine and eternal Savior could accomplish the redemption Scripture describes.

John 17:5 – “And now, Father, glorify Me in Your presence with the glory I had with You before the world existed.”

The glory Christ possessed with the Father *before the world existed* confirms the truth John established at the beginning of his Gospel:

“In the beginning was the Word.”

Jesus Christ did not begin at Bethlehem.

He was in the beginning.

And the Word who was with God, and who was God, became flesh and dwelt among us.